Parent and carer guide

A short summary of T Levels for parents and carers of students aged 16 to 19.

What is a T Level?

A T Level is a 2-year, Level 3 qualification taken after GCSEs. It is equivalent in size to 3 A levels. Each T Level focuses on one technical area, such as Digital, Business, Finance or Engineering.

How the time is split

- About 80% of the course is in the classroom.
- About 20% is an industry placement with an employer.
- The placement is at least 315 hours (about 45 days). It can be a block, day release or a mix.

Is the placement paid?

There is no legal requirement for T Level students to be paid on placement. Some employers choose to pay, so it's worth asking.

English and maths

Students who haven't got grade 4 in English and maths work towards it during the course, but they don't need it to pass the T Level.

What can it lead to?

- A skilled job
- A higher or degree apprenticeship
- A higher-level course or university degree

Questions you might ask the college

- How will my child's placement be found and supported?
- Who is the contact at the college during the placement?
- How will we hear about progress?

Sources: TLevels.gov.uk; GOV.UK Introduction of T Levels; GOV.UK T Level industry placements guidance. Checked 28 October 2026.